

Trillion 塾 第1回 共通テスト模試

英語 (リーディング)

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Question 1 (Long Reading) [配点 30 点]

Read the following passage and answer the questions below. Choose the best answer from ①～④ for each question.

In recent years, public health researchers have begun to identify a surprising new epidemic in modern societies: loneliness. Studies in the United States, the United Kingdom, and Japan all point to the same trend — despite being more "connected" than ever through digital technology, people report feeling more isolated than at any previous point in history. **(A)** This paradox, which scholars call the "connectivity paradox," challenges our basic assumptions about what makes us feel close to others.

One of the most striking findings is that the loneliest age group is not, as many would expect, the elderly. Instead, it is young adults in their late teens and twenties. A 2023 study found that nearly 70% of people aged 18 to 25 reported feeling lonely "often" or "always," compared to only 40% of those over 65. This generation, often called "digital natives," grew up with smartphones and social media, yet they appear to suffer most from social disconnection.

Why might this be the case? Researchers offer several explanations. First, social media platforms tend to display curated versions of people's lives — vacations, achievements, smiling photos — which can lead viewers to feel that their own lives are inadequate by comparison. **(B)** Even surrounded by digital "friends," many young people experience a constant low-level shame about not measuring up.

Second, online communication, while convenient, often lacks the depth of face-to-face interaction. A text message can convey information, but it cannot transmit the tone of voice, the small pauses, the eye contact that make conversation feel meaningful. The brain, evolved for in-person communication over hundreds of thousands of years, simply does not register a thousand "likes" the same way it registers a single hug.

Third, the very design of social media platforms encourages comparison rather than connection. Features like follower counts, view numbers, and engagement metrics turn relationships into competitions. **(C)** When friendship itself becomes a form of performance, intimacy becomes harder to achieve.

The consequences of widespread loneliness are not merely psychological. Research has linked chronic loneliness to higher rates of heart disease, weakened immune function, and even premature death. **(D)** Some researchers now argue that loneliness should be treated as a public health crisis on the same level as obesity or smoking.

What can be done? Solutions vary, but most experts agree on a few principles. Encouraging real-world community spaces — neighborhood cafes, public libraries, community centers — is essential. Teaching young people to recognize the difference between online "connection" and meaningful relationships is also important. And on an individual level, the simple act of meeting someone face-to-face, regularly and without distractions, may be one of the most powerful interventions available.

The connectivity paradox suggests something important: technology alone cannot solve human problems that are fundamentally about presence, attention, and time. (E) If we want to build a less lonely future, we may need to do something deeply counterintuitive — to spend less time connecting digitally, and more time simply being with one another.

(Adapted from a public health research summary)

Notes:

paradox — 逆説、矛盾

curated — 厳選された、編集された

intimacy — 親密さ

counterintuitive — 直感に反する

Question 1 (Long Reading) — Questions

Q1 1

According to the passage, what is the main idea of the 'connectivity paradox' (underlined part A)?

- ① Digital technology has made everyone more efficient at communication.
- ② Despite increased digital connection, people feel more isolated than ever.
- ③ Older generations are more lonely than younger generations.
- ④ Loneliness is decreasing thanks to social media platforms.

Q2 2

What does the underlined sentence (B) most likely mean?

- ① Young people are physically surrounded by friends in their daily lives.
- ② Young people feel happy because of their large online following.
- ③ Young people often feel their own lives are inferior compared to what they see online.
- ④ Young people are ashamed of having too many digital friends.

Q3 3

According to the passage, why is online communication less satisfying than in-person interaction?

- ① It is too slow and inconvenient to use.
- ② It is too expensive for most young people.
- ③ It lacks the nonverbal cues that make conversation feel meaningful.
- ④ It only allows people to communicate with strangers.

Q4

4

What does the underlined sentence (C) suggest about modern friendship?

- ① True friendship requires constant public display.
- ② Social media has made friendships stronger and deeper.
- ③ When friendship becomes about showing off, real closeness becomes difficult.
- ④ Performance and intimacy are essentially the same thing.

Q5

5

Which of the following is NOT mentioned in the passage as a consequence of chronic loneliness?

- ① Higher rates of heart disease
- ② Weakened immune function
- ③ Increased rates of premature death
- ④ Improved academic performance

Q6

6

What is the author's main conclusion (underlined part E)?

- ① We should completely stop using digital technology.
- ② We should spend more time on social media to feel less alone.
- ③ To reduce loneliness, we may need to spend more time in physical presence with others.
- ④ Technology will eventually solve the loneliness epidemic on its own.

Question 2 (Grammar) [配点 10 点]

Choose the best word or phrase from ①~④ to fill each blank.

Q7

7

By the time the meeting ended, we () for nearly three hours.

- ① have been talking
- ② had been talking
- ③ will be talking
- ④ are talking

Q8

8

Not only () the exam, but he also got the highest score in the class.

- ① he passed
- ② did he pass
- ③ he did pass
- ④ had he passed

Q9

9

() you have any questions, please feel free to contact me at any time.

- ① Should
- ② Were
- ③ Had
- ④ Did

Q10

10

She speaks English () she had been born and raised in America.

- ① as if
- ② even though
- ③ in case
- ④ so that

Q11

11

The book () cover is torn belongs to my younger brother.

- ① which
- ② whose
- ③ whom
- ④ of which

Question 3 (Writing) [配点 10 点]

TOPIC: Should young people limit their use of social media?

State your opinion in English in about 80-100 words. Give at least two reasons to support your position.

Q12

Write your essay below.